

Reading the Sky

A steady east wind means the collars will sing flat, and every ringer learns to read the sky before touching a striker.

Cloud bases below 600 feet sharpen a gavel; above 1,200 feet the sound spreads and loses its edge.

The Register recommends waiting out a sandstorm entirely; a gritty gavel is a broken kettle.
Fog is kinder: a gavel rung into fog carries twice as far and loses none of its temper.

Collar Maintenance

A collar cleaned at every silverpoint lasts a full season; one that is skipped cracks along the striking ridge.

Ringers polish with soft wool only, never with the abrasive pads sold at the harbor stalls.

A collar crack is called a whisper line, and any kettle with one is moored apart until re-silvered.

Winter Silence

When the lake freezes the kettles fall silent, and the sheds turn to mending nets and copying the Register.

The silence ends on the first open-water dawn, when the oldest ringer strikes the welcome gavel.